

What does it mean to “read between the lines”?

When reading a text, it is often possible to **infer** information that is not stated directly.

WHAT IS AN INFERENCE?

An inference is a conclusion you reach based on clues and evidence in the text plus your own background knowledge.

HOW IT WORKS

Information & arguments in the text + Your own background knowledge = Inference (what is probably true)

WHY IT MATTERS

- Helps you understand the deeper meaning.
- Makes you a critical and thoughtful reader.
- Used in everyday life, not just in reading!

THINK ABOUT...

- What clues does the author give me?
- What can I assume is probably true?
- What evidence in the text led me to this inference?

LOOK FOR CLUES

What characters say What characters do Descriptions & details Events & situations

EXAMPLE

Text: "She looked out the window and sighed. Her bag was packed by the door."
Inference: She is probably leaving or going on a trip.
Evidence: She sighed + her bag was packed.

Good readers don't just read the words, they understand what the words suggest.

Inference = Text clues + Background knowledge + Thinking
Put the clues together. Read between the lines!

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READING COMPREHENSION: INFERENCES

PRESENTER:
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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Analyze the implicit information in the text.

Learn to make inferences based on textual evidence.

Read the following paragraph carefully and answer the questions.

During a routine dental examination, Dr. Sana noticed that a 45-year-old patient had a small, painless white patch on the inside of his cheek. The patient said he had first noticed it three weeks earlier but had not considered it important because it did not hurt.

During the consultation, he mentioned that he had been using tobacco regularly for more than 15 years. Dr. Sana examined the lesion carefully and explained that although it might be harmless, it should not be ignored. She advised the patient to stop using tobacco and referred him to an oral medicine specialist for further assessment.

The patient appeared surprised because he felt completely healthy and had expected only a routine dental cleaning.

1. **What is the paragraph mainly about?**
2. **How long had the patient been using tobacco?**
3. **Why do you think the patient did not consider the white patch serious at first? Give evidence from the paragraph to support your answer.**
4. **What does Dr. Sana's decision to refer the patient to a specialist suggest about her approach to patient care?**

Key

1. Identifying a potentially serious oral condition.
2. More than 15 years.
3. Since the white patch was painless and the patient felt perfectly well, he did not take it seriously. Three weeks prior, he had also noticed it, but he did not consider it significant.

Evidence: “it did not hurt” and “he felt completely healthy.”

1. Despite the patient's lack of pain or other visible symptoms, Dr. Sana saw the issue as potentially dangerous and needed additional examination. Her choice to send him to a specialist demonstrates her professional responsibility and caution.

Evidence: She “examined the lesion carefully,” advised him to stop using tobacco, and referred him to an oral medicine specialist.

- Read the first paragraph of the reading passage. Then, refer to the Sustainable Development Goals infographic on page 66.
- 1. Which of these goals do you think are the most important?
- 2. Which goals do you think will be the easiest to achieve by 2030? Which will be the hardest to achieve?

In 2015 at the United Nations, world leaders adopted 17 Sustainable Development Goals aimed at reducing poverty, inequality, and other global problems by 2030. Such objectives have long been championed by philanthropists¹ Bill and Melinda Gates. In 2017, the Gates Foundation launched Goalkeepers, an **initiative** to spur action² and track progress toward the UN goals. Its 2018 status report says there have been “mind-blowing improvements in the human condition.” The report also calls for more **investment** and **innovation** to ensure this progress continues.

Read the text and note following. (15 minutes)

Identify the problems/challenges discussed.

Solutions proposed.

Post-reading

What drives the “goal keepers” to take actions?

How does the text suggest their work impacts society or the environment?

What is the tone of the text? (sarcastic, optimistic, objective, empathetic, authoritative)

READING COMPREHENSION : A

1. a — mostly optimistic

2. c — the fact that many countries are becoming totally self-sufficient

3. d — none of these three countries

4. b — Poverty is falling more slowly than in other regions

5. c — amazingly

6. c — training teachers and getting better classroom materials

7. a — Goal 2 (End hunger, promote improved nutrition and sustainable agriculture)



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READING COMPREHENSION : B

1. F — The Goalkeepers report was produced by the Gates Foundation, not the UN

2. NG — No information about a decrease in Africa since 2000

3. F — Nearly half of young people will live in Africa in the future, not currently

4. T — East & Southeast Asia are above world average in proficiency

5. F — Poverty in South Asia has been declining, not increasing

6. F — Central & South Asia are below world average in math proficiency

7. NG— no information



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READING SKILL

1. a — Member countries agreed to them

2. b — a lot of people aren't aware of the UN's progress

3. d — Countries should consider adopting successful ideas from around the world

4. c — It has been known for a long time that family planning is extremely important

HOME TASK:

Critical Thinking question on page 68 in the handout.

THANK YOU

Reference:

Reading Explorer 5, Unit 3B.